

1.7 Blogging Clients

Blogging clients exist in two flavours, there are those that exist online like blogger.com—you can prepare your blog using them, but you need to be online to do it. All blogging platforms have a client embedded.

Then there are clients in the form of stand-alone applications like Flock which allow you to create the blog post offline, but you need to be online to publish the post to the blog site (similar to creating and sending an e-mail using e-mail clients like Thunderbird). Flock, by the way, is also an able browser based on the Mozilla engine which also powers Firefox. Using Flock is described later in this chapter.

1.8 Blogging Platforms And Hosts

The Blogging Platform is the core of the blog's structure. All aspects of a blog, except the post content, are controlled by the platform. This ranges from the page colour and layout, to the way in which the posts are stored and retrieved. While all platforms include a blog client, which can only be used when the blogger is online; they do not come with the host bundled. This is contrary to common perception. Many platforms, especially those that are the result of the Open Source movement are freely downloadable. A user can install and configure the platform to work on a host.

There are many blogging platforms, and selection of one has to be in the light of the knowledge of the advantages and disadvantages of each. The popular blogging platforms include Blogger, Moveable Type, WordPress, TypePad, LiveJournal. etc.

Of these, WordPress and Moveable Type are freely downloadable. Moveable Type which is free for personal use is not available freely hosted—even with feature limitations. While